STRATEGIC VALUE PLUS SOLUTIONS, LLC (V+)

Manufacturing Performance · Federal Readiness · Digital Transformation

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October 22, 2026

U.S. Department of Energy, Office of Critical Minerals and Energy Innovation, c/o EnergyWerx — University-Based ITAC Opportunity, Track 1

Re: Letter of Commitment — Southern University Industrial Training and Assessment Center (SU ITAC)

Dear Review Committee:

Strategic Value Plus Solutions, LLC (V+) commits to serve as the primary implementation partner and a subrecipient to Southern University and A&M College for the proposed SU ITAC, led by Dr. Fareed Dawan, for all five budget periods.

Who we are. V+ is a manufacturing-performance and operational-transformation firm that helps small and mid-sized manufacturers (25–500 employees) modernize operations, qualify as OEM and defense suppliers, and meet federal requirements. Our organization includes more than 70 veteran manufacturing SMEs. We combine Theory of Constraints methods developed with Goldratt Research Labs, Lean and Quick Response Manufacturing, quality-system readiness (ISO 9001, AS9100, IATF 16949), CMMC and NIST SP 800-171 readiness, and Section 889 and ITAR supply-chain screening, delivered through our V+ EDGE platform. V+ is active in the Reshoring Initiative and the HUBZone small-business ecosystem.

Results. V+ advisors have raised on-time delivery from 0% to 100% while cutting product cost 16% at a Mississippi oil-and-gas equipment plant; raised on-time delivery from 38% to 97% and turned EBITDA from −55% to +24% at a Texas plant; increased output 40% at a North Carolina plant; and led an aerospace manufacturer to AS9100 certification. For a mining client, a V+ advisor's program saved $165 million over nine years, cut a one-week outage to 27.5 hours, trained more than 1,200 employees in continuous improvement, and sustained 3–5% annual cost reductions.

Our commitments to the SU ITAC:

- A V+ field engineer on every assessment site visit, coaching student teams on productivity and plant operations; our engineers will accept appointment as adjunct professors of practice in Mechanical Engineering.
- Productivity, Lean, and supplier-readiness modules in the student boot camp each January and August, within the curriculum Southern owns.
- A client pipeline from our network and regional outreach, with every lead screened against DOE's Track 1 criteria.
- Supplier-readiness screening for clients (CMMC, NIST SP 800-171, Section 889, ITAR, AS9100), implementation follow-up, and ITAC Implementation Grant packets.
- Incumbent-worker training with Louisiana technical colleges, including Lean and constraint-based throughput courses.
- The V+ EDGE platform for the Center's client pipeline and milestone dashboard.

Funding and cost share. V+ will perform this work under a subaward of $100,000 per budget period ($500,000 over five years). In addition, V+ commits **cost share of $20,000 per budget period ($100,000 total), type: in-kind**, consisting of field-engineer and senior-advisor hours not billed to the award.

Terms we accept. Southern owns the training curriculum, energy-technical instruction, report sign-off, and student certification; students perform all metering, analysis, and writing. V+ will follow Southern's site-safety, insurance, FERPA, and conflict-of-interest requirements. Assessments remain free to clients, recommendations never depend on any purchase, and any paid V+ follow-on work is optional for the client and disclosed to DOE.

Eligibility. V+ is a Delaware limited liability company, majority U.S.-owned and controlled, with a physical place of business in the United States. It is registered in SAM.gov, is not debarred, suspended, or otherwise excluded from federal programs, and is not owned by, controlled by, or subject to the jurisdiction or direction of the government of a Country of Risk.

Sincerely,

Nelinia Varenas



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